



Tenka Fubu

Total War: Shogun 2

Modlist & Guide

For the latest Steam version (patch 1.1.0, build 5934)

Three waves — three campaigns — one sword

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Wave 0: The Shimazu Way

Installation & Setup

This guide assumes a clean installation of Total War: SHOGUN 2 via Steam with no previous modifications.

Verifying Your Game Version

Open your Steam Library, right-click **Total War: SHOGUN 2**, select **Properties**, go to the **Installed Files** tab. Verify the game is on the latest version (which is auto-updated by Steam). The final build is patch 1.1.0, build 5934 (September 2013).

No Mods Required

Wave 0 is played on a completely vanilla game. Do NOT subscribe to any mods before starting this wave. The purpose of this wave is to learn the game's core systems from a clean state.

If you already have mods subscribed, unsubscribe from all of them before proceeding:

1. Open Steam Workshop for Shogun 2
2. "Your Files" → "Subscribed Items"
3. Unsubscribe from everything
4. Verify

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/user.script.txt
```

is empty or does not exist

5. Delete any

```
.pack
```

files in

```
steamapps/common/Total War Shogun 2/data/
```

that are not part of the base game

Launching the Game

1. Launch **Total War: SHOGUN 2** from Steam
2. The **Total War: Launcher** will appear
3. The mod list should be empty (no mods checked on)
4. Click **Play**

Starting a New Campaign

From the main menu:

1. Select **Single Player** → **New Campaign**
2. Select the **Shimazu** clan
3. Choose **Normal** difficulty (this is the intended experience for Wave 0)

4. Set Campaign length to **Short** for your first run
5. Leave all other settings at default
6. Click **Start**

First Loading Screen Tips

- Pay attention to the loading screen tips — they teach real mechanics
- The advisor (the floating face) can be toggled off with the top-left button, but keep it on for Wave 0
- Pause the game with **P** anytime during a battle

Saving and Loading

- The game auto-saves at the start of each turn
- Manual saves are recommended before any major battle (use **F5** for quick save)
- You can have multiple save files — rotate them so you can go back if needed

Wave 0: Mod List

This wave uses no gameplay-altering mods. The following are approved UI and quality-of-life improvements that do not change game mechanics.

Recommended UI / QoL Mods

Extended Camera Minimod

Extends the maximum zoom-out distance in battle, giving you a better tactical overview of the battlefield. Updated version by Gacsam — fixes crash issues that affected the original 13-year-old mod on modern game builds. No gameplay changes, purely a camera adjustment.

[Workshop page →](#)

Bugfixes

Better Naval Autoresolve

Fixes the notoriously punishing naval autoresolve results, where superior fleets would take disproportionate losses compared to land battles. Does not change any unit stats or game balance — only adjusts the autoresolve calculation to produce fairer outcomes.

[Workshop page →](#)

Icons Fix

Restores missing building icons (farms for all eras, Nanban trade ports) and fixes icon issues in the Gempei (Rise of the Samurai) campaign. Purely cosmetic — no gameplay changes.

[Workshop page →](#)

Better Ambush Deployment

Improves the deployment zone placement for ambush battles, giving attackers a more sensible starting position. Compatible with Fall of the Samurai and Rise of the Samurai.

[Workshop page →](#)

Upstart General Removal

Removes the random “Upstart General” event that could prematurely kill or displace your generals. A pure annoyance fix — no balance or gameplay changes.

[Workshop page →](#)

Leased Land Demolishable

Allows demolishing the Leased Land building chain, freeing up a slot if you no longer want the leased territory. Pure QoL — no stat or balance changes.

[Workshop page →](#)

What NOT to Install

For Wave 0, avoid any mod that:

- Changes unit stats or recruitment
- Alters the campaign map
- Adds new units or buildings
- Modifies AI behavior
- Changes any game balance values

The purpose of Wave 0 is to learn the game as designed. Save the modifications for later waves.

How to Play: Total War: SHOGUN 2

New Player Training Path

This guide teaches you the basics through your first 15 hours. Do not try to conquer Japan on your first campaign. Your goal is to learn how the game works, then restart with that knowledge.

Phase 0: The Tutorial (30 Minutes)

Launch the in-game tutorial from the main menu. Do not skip it. Shogun 2 has unique controls not found in other strategy games:

- **Space** pauses the game. While paused, issue orders to every unit. This is how you win battles — by giving every unit a job before unpausing.
- **Alt** + drag selects a formation width. Use this to set your battle line exactly where you want it.
- **Backspace** or **K** orders a unit to disengage from melee. They will take casualties while pulling back, but less than if they break and rout.
- **Insert** toggles advanced unit info. Turn this on and leave it on — it shows current health, fatigue, and morale for selected units.
- **Tab** cycles through units in the current group.
- **Shift** + click adds waypoints to a movement order. Use this to set up flanking routes before combat.

After the tutorial, play the historical battle **Battle of Okehazama** on Normal. This battle teaches the most important lesson in Shogun 2: a smaller army can destroy a larger one by attacking from the correct direction at the correct time.

Phase 1: Campaign Fundamentals (Hours 1–15)

Start as **Shimazu** on Normal difficulty with Short campaign length. Set battle timer to Unlimited. Set unit size to Large or Ultra.

Your first 15 hours are about one thing: the **economy loop**. Everything else depends on it.

—- The Economy Loop —-

Every province produces food, wealth, and population growth. These three numbers determine everything you can do:

Food: Each castle tier consumes a fixed amount of food (tier 1 = 2 food, tier 2 = 4 food, tier 3 = 6 food). Armies on the campaign map consume 1 food per army per turn. You see your food total in the top bar. Positive surplus gives +2 happiness in every province. Negative food causes -2 happiness per missing point, leading to rebellions.

Wealth: The total taxable value of a province. Tax rate (Low, Normal, High, Very High) multiplies this into your treasury. A province with 1000 wealth at Normal tax gives 300 koku per turn. Build markets and trade ports to increase wealth.

Growth: Population changes each turn based on food surplus, tax rate, and buildings. More population increases the province's wealth baseline. Farms are your primary growth engine. A province with +4 growth will double its wealth-producing population in roughly 20 turns.

The loop: build farms → food surplus increases growth → population grows → wealth increases → tax income rises → you afford more armies → you conquer more provinces with more farm slots.

—- Turn Structure —-

Every turn, in this order:

1. Check the top bar: is food positive? Is money positive?
2. Look at each province: is happiness above 70%? If not, fix it before building anything.
3. Build one thing per province that needs attention.
4. Recruit units in provinces with castles.
5. Move armies and agents.
6. End turn. Watch the AI turn for notifications (battles, events, agent actions).

—- Building Chains —-

Each province has 4-6 building slots depending on whether it is coastal. Every slot belongs to a specific category. You cannot build two buildings in the same category in one province.

The building categories and their upgrade paths:

Castle (military): Stronghold → Fortress → Citadel → Fortress of the First Rank. Each tier unlocks higher-tier units: tier 2 unlocks samurai spear and bow, tier 3 unlocks katana samurai and cavalry dojo upgrades, tier 4 unlocks matchlock units. Each tier also consumes +2 food and adds garrison units that appear when the province is besieged. **Build this when you need better troops, not before.**

Farm (food): Rice Paddies → Terraced Fields → Irrigation Ditches. Each upgrade increases food output and growth rate. Max tier farms produce 6-8 food. **Build this first in every province.**

Market (wealth): Local Market → Merchant Guild → Merchant Conclave. Each tier adds wealth and trade income. The top tier adds a significant faction-wide trade bonus. **Build this second after the farm.**

Temple (order/religion): Shinto Shrine → Grand Shrine. Increases happiness and converts province to your starting religion (Shinto for most clans, Christian if you convert). A province following your state religion gets +3 happiness. A province following a different religion gets -3 to -8 happiness depending on how many religions are present.

Port (trade/navy — coastal only): Fishing Village → Commercial Port → Military Port. Generates trade income and allows naval recruitment. Military ports unlock stronger warships.

Road (logistics): Unexplored Tracks → Well-Kept Road. Increases army movement speed within the province. Build on border provinces to react faster to invasions.

Sake Den (happiness/income — some provinces): Generates moderate wealth and small happiness bonus. The upgraded version adds larger wealth but causes a small public order penalty. Only build in provinces with excess happiness.

Library (research): Modest study → Scholar Dojo. Increases research rate for both military and civil technologies. Expensive but valuable in a long campaign. Build one dedicated library province.

—- Tax Rates and Honor —-

Your tax rate sets the percentage of wealth collected each turn:

- **Low:** +1 happiness, reduced income. Use during rebellions.
- **Normal:** Default. Balanced income.
- **High:** +20% income, -2 happiness.

- **Very High:** +40% income, -5 happiness, growth penalty.

Honor: Your clan's honor level (0-6) affects diplomacy acceptance rates and agent success chances. Breaking treaties, attacking allies, and using underhanded tactics reduces honor. Honorable actions (sparing defeated enemies, honoring alliances, granting safe passage) increase honor. Keep honor at 3+ for functional diplomacy.

Stabilizing a Struggling Economy

You will face economic crises in your first campaign. Here is how to recover:

Food emergency: If food turns negative, happiness drops by -2 per missing point. Rebels spawn at -10 happiness. Fix order: (1) reduce tax rate to Low for +1 happiness, (2) build a farm in the province with the lowest castle tier (farms complete faster in undeveloped provinces), (3) disband 1-2 army units (each army consumes 1 food per turn). A single farm upgrade (+4 food) fixes most food deficits.

Cash emergency: If your treasury drops below 500 koku and income is negative: (1) stop all construction, (2) reduce tax rate to Low (reduces happiness pressure, lets you grow population), (3) check which provinces have markets — if none, build one in your wealthiest province immediately, (4) move your army toward an enemy province you can conquer (capturing a province adds its tax base to your income). Do not recruit new units during a cash emergency unless you are about to be attacked.

Growing Your Economy Beyond the Basics

Once food is positive and cash is stable, shift to growth:

Province prioritization: Not all provinces are equal. Prioritize development in provinces with:

- Coastal slots (market + port = double wealth generation)
- Farm bonuses (some provinces have +20% farm output — build farms here first)
- Central location (provinces far from the front lines should be maxed economically since they will never need to produce troops)

The investment rule: A building that costs 600 koku and generates +100 koku per turn pays for itself in 6 turns and generates pure profit for the remaining 60+ turns of your campaign. Build early, profit later. Delaying a farm by 10 turns costs you roughly 1,000 koku in lost income over the campaign.

When to push taxes: Increase tax rate to High or Very High only when: (1) food surplus is +5 or higher, (2) happiness is above 85% in all provinces, (3) you need cash NOW for a military emergency. Run High tax for a maximum of 5 turns, then drop back to Normal. Very High tax should never run more than 2 consecutive turns.

Trade node awareness: Look at the naval map overlay. The four offshore trade nodes are visible from turn 1. You do not need a navy to occupy them — a single trade ship (Bow Kobaya, 200 koku) sent to a node generates 500-1,500 koku per turn. Building one trade ship in your first 10 turns and sending it to the nearest node is often the single highest-ROI investment you can make.

—- Army Composition for the First Campaign —-

Your first army should be:

Core (6 units): Yari Ashigaru. They are cheap, fast to recruit, and their **yari wall** formation is the strongest defensive formation in the game. A yari wall gives +15 bonus against cavalry, negates

charge bonus, and adds mass (units cannot push through). Form yari wall by selecting the unit and clicking the wall button or pressing **B**.

Missile (4 units): Bow Ashigaru. They are fragile but cheap. Keep them behind the yari wall. Turn off **fire at will** (press F) until the enemy enters range, then turn it on to preserve ammunition. Wait until the enemy is at 150 units distance before shooting.

Flank (2 units): Yari Cavalry. You do not have a cavalry dojo yet, so these come from the basic recruitment pool. They are weak in a frontal charge but deadly from the rear. Charge (press **R**) into the back of an engaged enemy unit. The charge bonus + morale penalty from being hit in the rear will route most units instantly.

Total: 12 units. This fits under your general's command limit (16 units at rank 1) and costs roughly 800 koku per turn to maintain.

Do NOT recruit samurai in your first 20 turns. They cost 2-3x more than ashigaru, take 2 turns to recruit, and require castle upgrades you cannot afford yet.

—- Combat Mechanics —-

Shogun 2's battle system is driven by four hidden numbers:

Morale: Every unit has a morale value (ashigaru: 6-8, samurai: 10-16, elite: 18-22). Morale damage comes from: taking casualties (biggest factor), being flanked (-8), having the general killed (-12 to all units), being hit in the rear (-8), being charged by cavalry (-4), taking fire without being able to return it (-2 per volley). When morale hits 0, the unit routs. Routing units that are chased off the battlefield are permanently destroyed.

Fatigue: Units have four fatigue states: fresh → active → tired → exhausted. Exhausted units fight at 50% effectiveness, rout faster, and move slower. Running, fighting, climbing walls, and wading through rivers causes fatigue. Walking and standing restores it. **March your armies to the battlefield, do not run them.**

Armor and Attack: Each unit has melee attack (chance to hit), melee defense (chance to block), armor (damage reduction), and weapon damage. A katana samurai has 12 attack, 10 defense, 6 armor, and 12 damage. A yari ashigaru has 4 attack, 4 defense, 3 armor, and 7 damage. The samurai wins in a straight fight — but the ashigaru costs half as much and gets yari wall.

Charge Bonus: Cavalry and shock infantry get a charge bonus added to their attack on the first hit. Yari cavalry have 15 charge bonus. This is why cavalry cycles out of combat and recharges — the second charge gets the bonus again.

—- Your First Battle: Step by Step —-

1. Before the battle starts, deploy your army. Click and drag to set formation width. Put yari in front, bows behind, cavalry on a flank.
2. Once deployed, pause (Space). Give movement orders to every unit so they advance in formation.
3. Unpause. The armies approach. Your bow units will start shooting automatically. Let them.
4. When the enemy infantry is 50 units from your line, pause again. Order your cavalry to move wide around the enemy flank — outside the enemy's visible range if possible.
5. Unpause. The lines clash. Watch the yari wall icon — it needs to be active.
6. While the lines are engaged, pause. Order your cavalry to charge the rear of an enemy unit that is already fighting your yari. Use the charge ability (R) from about 150 units distance.

7. That enemy unit will rout almost instantly. Your cavalry bounces out of combat (they auto-disengage after a charge). Order them to charge the next engaged enemy unit in the rear.
8. Repeat step 7 until the enemy line breaks. Once 2-3 units rout, nearby units start checking their own morale and often rout too — a chain rout.

This tactic (yari wall + cavalry flanking) wins 90% of your battles for the entire early and mid game.

Your First 10 Turns: Walkthrough

Turn 1: Open Satsuma province. Build a Farm upgrade (costs 600 koku, takes 2 turns). Recruit 2 yari ashigaru (costs 300 koku, takes 1 turn). Move your general's army northeast toward the Ito border. End turn.

Turn 2: Farm completes. Build a Market in Satsuma (400 koku, 2 turns). Recruit 2 more yari ashigaru. Move army to the border with Ito. End turn.

Turn 3: Market completes. Recruit 2 bow ashigaru. Move into Ito territory. The Ito may attack you — if they do, fight manually. Auto-resolve favors the AI at the start of the game. If they do not attack, move next to their castle and begin a siege. Build a siege tower (2 turns to build). While building, your army blocks all movement out of the castle.

Turn 4: Keep building the siege tower. Recruit 1 more yari ashigaru in Satsuma. Check happiness — if below 70%, reduce tax rate to Low for one turn.

Turn 5: Siege tower completes. Attack the castle. Deploy your army: yari in front, bows behind. The siege tower automatically moves to the wall when you click on it. Your troops climb and fight on the walls. The defender gets a combat bonus on walls, so send 2-3 units per tower. Once you control one wall section, send infantry through to capture the center.

Turns 6-8: Capture Ito province. Build a Farm, then a Market. Recruit more ashigaru. Scout east toward Sagara territory. Do not declare war — let them attack you while you develop.

Turns 9-10: You now control two provinces. Stabilize happiness. Watch the food bar. If positive, build another farm or improve the castle. If negative, build a farm immediately. Save the game before your next war.

Victory Conditions

Short Campaign victory (Shimazu):

- Control 20 provinces (includes Kyushu island + southern Honshu)
- Survive Realm Divide
- Eliminate the 2 rival clans on your victory screen

You will trigger Realm Divide when you approach 25+ provinces. All surviving clans declare war on you at once. This is the final exam of every campaign. Surviving Realm Divide is covered in Wave 2's guide.

When to Move to Wave 1

You are ready to move forward when:

- You completed one campaign on Normal difficulty
- You understand which buildings to build in which order
- You can win basic battles using yari wall + cavalry without heavy losses
- You know what the three top-bar numbers (koku, food, honor) mean and how to adjust them

Start Wave 1 to learn army composition, agents, trade, and how to prepare for Realm Divide.

Wave 1: Tenka Fubu

Installation & Setup

Wave 1 introduces visual, unit, and faction mods. You must have completed at least one vanilla campaign before starting this wave.

Resetting user.script.txt

Before adding mods, clear your previous load order:

1. Navigate to

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/
```

2. Open

```
user.script.txt
```

in Notepad

3. Delete all lines or rename the file to

```
user.script.bak
```

4. Save the blank file

Mod Installation (Steam Workshop)

1. Open the **Total War: SHOGUN 2** Workshop on Steam
2. For each mod listed in 02-mods.typ, click **Subscribe**
3. Steam will download the

```
.pack
```

files to your data directory

4. Launch the game — the launcher will show available mods

Configuring Load Order in user.script.txt

After subscribing to all Wave 1 mods:

1. Launch the game once via the launcher (this auto-generates

```
user.script.txt
```

)

2. **Alternatively:** manually create/edit

```
user.script.txt
```

in

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/
```

3. Each line should read:

```
mod "filename.pack";
```

4. Mods load top-to-bottom — later entries override earlier ones.
5. Save the file.

Wave 1 Load Order

NOTE: Specific mods TBD. Load order template will be filled when mods are selected.

Starting a New Campaign

From the main menu:

1. Select **Single Player** → **New Campaign**
2. Select the **Oda** clan
3. Difficulty: **Hard** (you have experience now — time to earn it)
4. Campaign length: **Long**
5. Enable the following mod-launcher checkboxes if available: *TBD*
6. Click **Start**

Verifying Mods Are Active

In-game indicators that mods are loaded:

- Different loading screen art
- New units visible in recruitment menu
- Faction-specific visual changes
- If nothing looks different, check

```
user.script.txt
```

and that pack files exist in the data directory

Wave 1: Mod List

Wave 1 adds graphics enhancements, new unit packs, and faction expansions. No total overhauls — the game remains recognizable.

Map Improvements

Strongholds Of The Samurai

5-part mod providing 36 historically accurate castle maps for campaign siege battles. Each settlement type and level receives a unique, hand-crafted map that replaces the generic vanilla layouts. The AI handles the complex castle designs well, but be aware of a known issue: when defending, cavalry and generals may spawn underground on some maps. Move all units inside the walls during deployment before starting the battle.

- Part 1: [link](#)
- Part 2: [link](#)
- Part 3: [link](#)
- Part 4: [link](#)
- Part 5: [link](#)

Last updated: September 2020. [116K+ subscribers](#).

[Workshop page →](#)

Graphics Enhancements

Bullgod's Horse Texture Mod

Crisper, higher-quality horse textures with darker reins and improved manes. Affects all cavalry units — light, heavy, and general's bodyguard. Purely visual, no stat changes.

[Workshop page →](#)

Campaign Map Visuals

Castle Campaign Map Models

Replaces the generic vanilla castle models on the campaign map with detailed, tier-specific designs. Each fortress level gets a unique visual — citadels and Kyoto have their own distinct look. Visual only; does not affect battle maps or siege layouts.

- Level 1: [link](#)
- Level 2: [link](#)
- Level 3: [link](#)
- Level 4: [link](#)
- Level 5 (includes Kyoto): [link](#)

[Workshop page →](#)

Immersion

Campaign Unit Stealth (Vanilla)

Grants Kisho Ninja and Yugekitai units the ability to hide in plain sight on the campaign map, matching their battlefield stealth role. Works with vanilla units only — not compatible with third-party unit packs. For use in Sengoku and Fall of the Samurai campaigns.

[Workshop page →](#)

Unit Packs

Weierstrass Units for Vanilla

Adds new historically-inspired units to the vanilla roster without overhauling existing balance. Designed to integrate cleanly with the base game's unit tiers and faction identities. Part 1 of the Weierstrass unit series.

- Part 1: [link](#)

[Workshop page →](#)

Updated Wako Units + Pirate Ports + Imperial/Black Ship

Overhauls the Wako pirate faction with updated unit rosters and adds new pirate port infrastructure. Also includes the Imperial Trade Ship and Black Ship units for naval variety. Builds on vanilla naval and faction systems without breaking existing balance.

[Workshop page →](#)

Faction Expansions

Recruitable Generals (No Horo)

Allows recruiting generals directly without the horo (the distinctive cape/balloon worn by mounted commanders). Gives you more control over your general pool while keeping recruitment costs and limits intact. Purely an immersion and roster management improvement.

[Workshop page →](#)

Compatibility Notes

All Wave 1 mods are selected for mutual compatibility. If you experience crashes, verify:

1. Load order matches 01-setup.typ
2. No Wave 2 mods are accidentally subscribed
3. No mod from Wave 0 that conflicts is still active

Strategy & Tactics: Intermediate

This guide assumes you completed a campaign on Normal. Here we cover army composition, battle tactics, agents, trade, and how to survive until Realm Divide.

Phase 2: Military Mastery

Army Composition by Era

Your army changes as the game progresses. Do not use the same army at turn 10 and turn 60.

Early game (turns 1-20, castle tiers 1-2): 8 yari ashigaru (anvil), 4 bow ashigaru (support), 2 yari cavalry (flank), 1 general. This costs roughly 1,000-1,200 koku per turn. Do not deviate from this. You cannot afford samurai.

Mid game (turns 20-50, castle tier 3): 4 yari ashigaru (keep them for yari wall), 4 katana samurai (the new anvil once lines are pinned), 2-3 naginata samurai (anti-cavalry reserve), 4 bow samurai (replaces bow ashigaru), 4 cavalry (2 yari + 2 katana cavalry), 1 general. Costs roughly 2,500-3,500 koku per turn. Replace units as they die, not all at once.

Late game (turns 50+, castle tier 4): 2 yari ashigaru (still useful for yari wall), 6 katana samurai, 4 naginata samurai, 2 matchlock ashigaru or samurai, 4 bow samurai, 4 katana cavalry, 1 general. Costs 5,000+ koku per turn. At this point you should have 3-4 such armies.

The Unit Triangle: Exact Mechanics

Every unit in Shogun 2 has three stats that determine matchups:

Melee attack: The chance to land a hit per swing. Katana samurai: 12-14. Yari ashigaru: 4-6. A katana samurai hits twice as often as an ashigaru.

Melee defense: The chance to block an incoming hit. Yari ashigaru in yari wall: +4 bonus (total 8-10). Katana samurai: 10-12. Naginata: 14-16 (best defensive unit in the game).

Charge bonus: Added to melee attack on the first hit after a charge. Cavalry: 15-25. Katana samurai: 5-8. This is why cavalry must charge in and pull out — the bonus only applies on the first hit, then degrades.

The rock-paper-scissors:

- **Yari beat cavalry** because yari wall gives +15 bonus vs cavalry charge and negates the enemy's charge bonus entirely. A cavalry unit charging yari wall attacks at its base melee attack (10-12) against the yari's melee defense (8-10) plus the +15 wall bonus — the cavalry cannot hit reliably while the yari chews them up.
- **Katana beat yari** because katana samurai have 2x the melee attack of yari ashigaru and high armor (6-8 vs yari's 2-3). They cut through the yari's defense faster than the yari can retaliate.
- **Cavalry beat ranged and flank** because ranged units have zero melee defense and cannot fight back. A cavalry charge into the rear of any unit adds a -8 morale penalty and negates shields, making the charge 3x more effective than a frontal charge.

Matchlock Units: Timing and Line of Sight

Matchlock ashigaru and samurai (available at castle tier 3-4 with the gunpowder tech researched) are the most powerful ranged units in the game IF you use them correctly.

- Matchlocks have a flat trajectory. They cannot shoot over your own infantry. You must create gaps in your front line for matchlocks to shoot through, or position them on a flank.

- Matchlocks have extremely long reload time. One volley every 20-30 seconds. Make each volley count.
- Matchlocks cause morale shock. A unit hit by a matchlock volley takes a -2 to -4 morale penalty on top of casualties. Two volleys into the same unit will cause it to waver.
- Matchlocks are useless in rain. Rain reduces their accuracy by 80%. Check the weather overlay before deploying.

To use matchlocks effectively: deploy your yari line in a shallow formation (2 ranks wide), place matchlocks 10-15 units behind the gaps between yari units. The matchlocks shoot through the gaps. When the enemy infantry reaches your line, order your matchlocks to flank and shoot into the enemy's flank — they will not hit your own troops this way.

Advanced Battle Tactics

Hammer and Anvil (standard):

1. Yari advances and engages the enemy line. Formation: yari wall, 4 ranks deep.
2. Cavalry moves wide — outside the enemy's line of sight if possible (use forests, hills).
3. Cavalry charges the rear of an engaged enemy unit. The target routes almost instantly.
4. The routing unit causes nearby enemies to check morale. Often 2-3 more units rout.
5. Repeat until the entire enemy line breaks.

Defense in Depth (outnumbered):

1. Deploy on a hill. High ground gives a combat bonus (roughly +2 melee attack to the uphill side).
2. Place yari at the hill's crest, bows on the reverse slope. Enemy bow units cannot shoot what they cannot see.
3. When the enemy charges uphill, they arrive exhausted (fatigue penalty). Exhausted units fight at 50% effectiveness.
4. Counter-charge downhill with cavalry for maximum charge bonus.

The Feigned Retreat (advanced, multiplayer-proven):

1. Select a cheap unit (yari ashigaru) and order them to retreat through a gap in your line.
2. The enemy AI often pursues the retreating unit, breaking their formation.
3. Hit the exposed enemy flank with your cavalry or katana reserve.

Terrain Mastery: What Every Battlefield Tells You

The battlefield is not a flat arena. Every terrain feature creates advantages you must exploit and dangers you must avoid:

Hills: Units at higher elevation gain +2 melee attack against units below them. Archers on a hill gain +20% range and can shoot over friendly units in front of them (partial line of sight bypass). The uphill charging penalty adds fatigue — a unit that charges uphill arrives exhausted, fighting at 50% effectiveness. Always deploy on the highest ground available. If the enemy holds the hill, do not charge — make them come down to you.

Forests: Units inside a forest cannot be seen until the enemy is within 30 units. Forest battles reduce cavalry effectiveness by 40% (cavalry cannot charge through trees). Yari and katana infantry fight at normal effectiveness in forests. If the enemy has more cavalry than you, draw them into forest terrain. If you have cavalry, keep the battle in open ground.

Rivers: Crossing a river gives the crossing unit a severe fatigue penalty (fresh to tired after crossing). While crossing, units are extremely vulnerable — they cannot fight back effectively

and are packed tightly. Never cross a river in sight of the enemy. If the AI crosses a river to reach you, hit them as they emerge on your bank.

Villages and settlements: Buildings block line of sight and movement. A yari unit placed in a village street can hold off 3x its number because only 2-3 models can engage at once. Use villages as force multipliers when outnumbered. Do not chase enemies through villages — let them come to you.

Weather and Time of Day

Rain: Rain reduces matchlock accuracy by 80%. Bow units also take a penalty (roughly -30% accuracy). Yari and katana fight at normal effectiveness in rain. Check the weather overlay on the deployment screen. If you have matchlocks and it is raining, either wait (if the AI will attack) or deploy your matchlocks as melee reserves instead.

Night battles: A general with the Night Fighter skill (unlocked at rank 3+) can fight night battles. During a night battle, both sides have reduced visibility (roughly 50% range reduction for ranged units). The defender loses their wall combat bonus. Use night battles to assault castles with fewer casualties, or to force a battle against a larger army that would normally avoid fighting.

General Abilities and Retinue

Your general is the most important unit in every battle. Level them deliberately:

Essential skills (take these first on every general):

- **Stand Firm (rank 1):** Reduces morale shock to nearby units. Your line will not break as easily.
- **Night Fighter (rank 3):** Unlocks night battles. Use to fight at 2:1 odds.
- **Hold the Line (rank 5):** All units within the general's aura fight at +2 melee defense.
- **Second Wind (rank 7):** Reduces fatigue for nearby units. Keeps your line fresh.

Retinue items to watch for:

- **Warrior (any):** +1 melee attack to the general's bodyguard. Good for aggressive play.
- **Engineer:** +25% siege construction speed. Put this on your siege army general.
- **Strategist:** +5% movement range for the army. Excellent for reaction speed.
- **Ninja:** +2% chance to detect enemy agents in the army's province.

General death: If your general dies, all units within his aura take an immediate -12 morale penalty and lose all general bonuses. Units far from the general check morale independently — they are at risk of routing immediately. Protect your general. If he is in danger, pull him back behind the line. A dead general loses you the battle more often than any other single mistake.

Countering Specific Army Compositions

Vs cavalry-heavy (Takeda):

- Deploy on a hill or in a forest. Cavalry cannot charge uphill effectively or charge through trees.
- Use yari wall across your entire front line. Every yari unit must be in wall formation before contact.
- Place naginata (if available) on the flanks. Naginata have the highest melee defense and can hold against cavalry longer than yari.
- Keep your general inside the yari line. A charging cavalry general can kill your general in one charge if he is exposed.
- Do not let your bow units fire at charging cavalry — they will not kill enough before contact, and your bow units will be caught without protection.

Vs matchlock-heavy (Otomo):

- Matchlocks cannot shoot through their own units. If the enemy has many matchlocks, they will deploy them on flanks or in gaps.
- Spread your formation wide to force their matchlocks to reposition. Matchlocks move at half speed while loaded.
- Rush with cavalry. Matchlocks have zero melee defense. A single cavalry charge into a matchlock unit destroys it permanently.
- Use forests. Matchlocks need line of sight and forests block it completely.

Vs monk-heavy (Ikko-Ikki):

- Warrior monks have high attack, high morale, and cause fear. They will beat your ashigaru in a straight fight.
- Monks have no armor. Bow fire is extremely effective against them. Focus all bow fire on monk units.
- Monk units have small unit sizes (40-60 models vs 120-160 for ashigaru). They lose combat effectiveness quickly as models die.
- Engage monks with multiple units simultaneously. A single katana unit will lose to a warrior monk unit. Two katana units will win.

Siege defense (outnumbered):

- The defender has enormous advantages. Use them.
- Place bow units on the walls. They get unlimited ammunition and +20% range from wall height.
- Use oil at the gate. One oil pour kills 80-120 models. Time it for when the enemy is densely packed at the gate.
- Do not defend all wall sections equally. Concentrate your best units on one section and let the enemy take the others, then counter-attack to retake walls.
- Your general should stay in the castle center. His aura covers units on the walls if positioned correctly.

Agent Operations: Skill Trees and Strategy

– Metsuke –

Metsuke are your economic backbone. Every metsuke should specialize:

Economic metsuke (primary):

- Skill: Strengthen Town (every turn in your wealthiest province)
- Skill: Oversight (passive tax bonus in the province)
- Skill: Crackdown (suppress enemy agents)
- Promotion path: stay in one province until rank 4, then rotate to the next wealthiest
- A rank-4 economic metsuke adds roughly 30-50% to a province's tax output

Enforcement metsuke (secondary):

- Skill: Arrest (remove enemy ninja and monks)
- Skill: Investigate (find enemy agents)
- Counter-agent role. Place in provinces with high enemy agent activity.
- Can also be embedded in armies to root out enemy agents on the campaign map

Oversight metsuke (tertiary — late game):

- Skill: Oversight (all levels)
- Station in military recruitment provinces. Reduces recruitment cost and time.
- A rank-3 oversight metsuke can reduce recruitment costs by 20%.

– Ninja –

Ninja are your offensive arm. Each ninja should have ONE primary role:

Assassination ninja:

- Skills: Way of the Wind (movement), Shadow (assassination chance), Silent Strike (bonus vs generals)
- Target: enemy generals (removes the army's morale anchor), enemy metsuke (opening their provinces), enemy monks
- Never use your assassination ninja for sabotage — they level slower on sabotage XP

Sabotage ninja:

- Skills: Sabotage (buildings), Arson (castle damage), Way of the Earth (survival)
- Target: enemy recruitment buildings (prevents new units), castle walls (reduces siege defense)
- A high-rank sabotage ninja can destroy a castle's walls in one turn, making siege assault trivial

Scout ninja:

- Skills: Way of the Wind (movement), Way of Water (rivers), Eyes of the Lord (visibility)
- Use: keep ahead of your main army, scout enemy army composition, detect ambushes
- Place in forests near expected enemy approach routes

– Monks –

Monks handle religion and morale. Every province has a religion split between Shinto and Buddhism (plus Christianity if you convert).

Religious conversion (primary):

- Your starting clan has a state religion (Shimazu: Shinto, Oda: Shinto, Tokugawa: Shinto).
- Provinces with your state religion get +3-5 happiness.
- Provinces with opposing religions stack penalties: -3 per non-state religion present.
- A province with Shinto 80% and Buddhism 20% has Buddhism at 20%: -3 happiness.
- Use your monk's Convert action each turn in provinces with the wrong religion.

Warrior monk (combat embed):

- Skills: Warrior (melee attack), Inspiration (morale boost to nearby units), Levies (recruit monk units)
- Embed in your main army. The Inspiration aura adds +4 morale to nearby units.
- Monks can also recruit Warrior Monk units — some of the best infantry in the game (high attack, high morale, causes fear).
- A rank-3 Warrior Monk embedded in an army turns a standard army into an elite force.

Inciter (offensive):

- Skills: Incite Revolt (reduces happiness in target province), Insurrection (triggers a rebel army)
- Use: target a province you plan to attack. Incite revolt reduces the garrison's morale. If a rebel army spawns, it fights the garrison — your army arrives afterward to mop up.

Trade and Diplomacy

– Trade Nodes –

There are four offshore trade nodes on the naval map. Each provides trade goods worth 500-1,500 koku per turn depending on the node. Sending a trade ship to a node establishes a trade route. The ship auto-returns income each turn.

- Control of trade nodes is the difference between a struggling economy and a booming one.
- Each trade node can support 4 trade ships from your faction.
- Enemy clan trade nodes can be attacked. Sinking a trade ship does not declare war; blockading a node does.
- The Black Ship (Portuguese, appears near Kyushu in late game) is not a trade node but a unique ship. Capture it by boarding — it dominates any naval engagement for the rest of the game.

– Diplomacy Mechanics –

Diplomacy operates on a hidden relationship score (-200 to +200). Every action modifies this score:

Positive actions: honoring alliances (+30), giving gifts (+5 per 1,000 koku), marrying a daughter (+20), granting military access (+15), liberating captured provinces (+40 to the liberated clan)

Negative actions: breaking alliances (-40), refuse alliance request (-10), attacking allies (-80), trespassing (-5 per turn), territory expansion near their borders (-2 per province per turn)

Marriage: Marrying a daughter to another clan's daimyo creates an alliance that lasts 15-25 turns. After that, the alliance may break. Marriage does not prevent war — it delays it. Use marriage to secure one border while expanding on the other.

Alliance strategy: Never have more than 2 active alliances. Each alliance reduces the Realm Divide trigger threshold by roughly 2 provinces. Having 4 alliances means Realm Divide triggers at 18 provinces instead of 25.

Wave 1 Progression (Oda Clan)

1. **Turns 1-15:** Unify Owari province. Build farms and markets. Recruit ashigaru core. Do NOT attack the Ikko-Ikki early — they have high happiness and multiple stacks.
2. **Turns 15-30:** Expand east toward Kyoto. Take one province per 4 turns. Use marriage to keep the western clans (Mori, Otomo) neutral.
3. **Turns 30-50:** Capture Kyoto. The shogunate will be angry. Do not let yourself become Shogun yet — wait until you have 4 full armies.
4. **Turns 50-80:** Expand west and north simultaneously. Fortify Kyoto. Build trading ports and claim the western trade nodes.
5. **Turns 80+:** Realm Divide should trigger at 25 provinces. You want 4 full armies, 20,000+ koku, and strong garrisons on all borders before this happens.

Wave 2: Sekigahara's Shadow

Installation & Setup

Wave 2 introduces campaign overhauls, expanded mechanics, and deeper systems. This is the definitive Tenka Fubu experience. You must have completed at least one campaign on Hard difficulty.

Pre-Installation Cleanup

1. Open

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/user.script.txt
```

2. Back up your Wave 1 configuration: save a copy as

```
user.script.wave1.bak
```

3. Clear the file for a fresh Wave 2 load order

Mod Installation

Follow the same procedure as Wave 1 (Steam Workshop subscription). For any mods hosted on Total War Center:

1. Download the

```
.pack
```

file(s) from the provided link

2. Place them in

```
steamapps/common/Total War Shogun 2/data/
```

3. Add the filename to

```
user.script.txt
```

in the correct position

Wave 2 Load Order

NOTE: Specific mods TBD. Load order template will be filled when mods are selected.

General principles for Wave 2 load order:

- **Gameplay overhauls first** (foundational changes to mechanics)
- **Expanded maps/map modifications second**
- **Unit packs third** (these override unit tables)
- **Visual/graphics mods last** (least likely to conflict)

Starting a New Campaign

1. Select **Single Player** → **New Campaign**
2. Select the **Tokugawa** clan
3. Difficulty: **Hard** or **Very Hard**
4. Campaign length: **Long**
5. Click **Start**

Troubleshooting Wave 2 Conflicts

If the game crashes on launch or campaign start:

1. Disable mods one at a time to isolate the conflict
2. Check

```
conflicts.md
```

for known incompatibilities

3. Verify every mod's Workshop page for update status
4. Post in the Tenka Fubu discussion thread if stuck

Wave 2: Mod List

Wave 2 introduces campaign overhauls, expanded maps, and deeper mechanics. These mods significantly change how the game plays.

Expanded Mechanics

Sinkable Ships

Ships can now be sunk by sustained ranged fire (arrows, bullets, cannon) rather than only through boarding. Makes naval battles more dynamic and realistic — ranged supremacy becomes a viable strategy at sea, and every engagement carries greater risk for both sides.

[Workshop page →](#)

Kneel Fire for Matchlocks

Grants matchlock-armed units the Kneel Fire ability: the front rank kneels so the rear rank can fire over them, doubling volley density. A historically authentic formation that gives matchlock units a tactical edge in defensive positions. Both the player and AI can use it.

[Workshop page →](#)

New Unique Garrison Retainers

Replaces generic garrison units with unique retainer compositions that vary by clan and castle level. Makes defending settlements feel more thematic and gives each clan's home territory a distinctive defensive character. Compatible with vanilla campaigns.

[Workshop page →](#)

Campaign Pacing

12 Turns per Year (Shogun 2 + RotS, with Otomo fix)

Changes the campaign calendar from 4 turns per year to 12 turns per year (3 per season). This extends the Sengoku campaign from 154 turns to 660 turns, and Rise of the Samurai to 350 turns. Both the player and AI operate on the same calendar — this is a pacing preference, not a cheat. Characters age more slowly relative to progress, and you have more time to prepare before Realm Divide triggers at the historical date. Updated version by Ravonator: fixes the Otomo DLC crash present in the original mod, and correctly extends the Shogunate-hold requirement to 12 rounds instead of 4. Works in multiplayer campaigns.

- Total turns (Sengoku): 660
- Total turns (RotS): 350

[Workshop page →](#)

AI & Difficulty Mods

UAI Updated (RotS support) with Yarki's Reduced AI Cheating

An update to TheHedgeKnight's Universal AI mod. The AI gives more weight to military strength in diplomacy, plays safer with naval invasions, defends borders more actively, and is less fixated on producing light ships. Also includes Yarki's Reduced AI Cheating — on Easy and Normal difficulty, the AI plays with the same resistance to public order penalties as the player, rather than receiving hidden buffs. All UAI improvements are ported to Rise of the Samurai. Out-of-scope changes from the original UAI (diplomatic attitudes, event generation) have been reverted for broader compatibility. Last updated: September 2020.

[Workshop page →](#)

Compatibility Notes

Wave 2 mods have the highest potential for conflicts. Always:

1. Read the full Workshop description for known incompatibilities
2. Check the last-updated date
3. Review recent comments before subscribing
4. Test with a new campaign (not a saved game) after changing load order

Advanced Play: Expert Mechanics

Phase 3: Realm Divide & High-Level Strategy

How Realm Divide Actually Works

Realm Divide is not a fixed threshold. It is a hidden **fame** score that accumulates from everything you do:

- Owning provinces: +2 fame per province above 20
- Becoming Shogun (holding Kyoto for 4 consecutive turns): +40 fame
- Destroying a major clan (eliminating every member): +15 fame
- Winning heroic victories: +2-5 fame per battle
- Alliances: -2 fame per alliance (alliances delay the Divide, they do not eliminate it)

When your fame score reaches 75 (on Normal), Realm Divide triggers. On Hard the threshold is 65. On Very Hard it is 55.

The turn Realm Divide triggers, every surviving clan that has no treaties with you automatically declares war. Clans that have active treaties (non-aggression, trade, alliance) get a choice — they may join you, stay neutral, or join the coalition against you. Most will join against you.

The only way to prevent Realm Divide is to never reach the fame threshold. This means staying below 22 provinces (the safe zone) or avoiding heroic victories. Since you must reach 25+ provinces for a Short Campaign victory, Realm Divide is mandatory for completing the game.

Pre-Divide Preparation (Turns 10-20 Before)

Start preparing 10-20 turns before you expect Realm Divide. The timing is predictable if you count provinces: divide triggers 1-3 turns after you cross 25 provinces.

Military preparation:

- Every border province gets a castle upgrade (minimum tier 3). A tier-3 castle has walls, oil, and a garrison of 8 units. The AI will waste 3-5 turns besieging each one.
- Every army should be at 18-20 units. Do not have partial stacks when Divide triggers.
- Station one full army at each border region. You need 1 army per 3-4 border provinces.
- Your main army (the best general, the best units) stays in a central position where it can reinforce any border within 2 turns.

Economic preparation:

- Stockpile 20,000-30,000 koku. You will not be able to trade after Divide triggers.
- All provinces that can build a market should build a market. Your peacetime economy must support wartime spending.
- Build roads on all border provinces. Faster army movement means you can defend twice as many provinces with the same number of armies.

Diplomatic preparation:

- Break all alliances 5-10 turns before you expect Divide. Each broken alliance costs -10 honor, but a clan that is neutral toward you has a small chance of staying neutral during Divide. A clan that is allied when Divide triggers gets a massive diplomacy penalty — they almost always join the coalition.
- Leave 1-2 non-aggression pacts active. These give a small chance the clan stays neutral.
- Give small gifts (1,000 koku) to your most powerful neighbors. This improves their relationship score, making them slightly more likely to stay neutral.

Post-Divide Strategy: The First 10 Turns

The first 10 turns after Realm Divide determine whether you survive. The AI has a massive military advantage at this point — every clan in Japan has full armies and they all target you.

Turn 1-3 (the initial wave):

- Do not advance anywhere. Pull back all armies to defensive positions.
- Every army should be inside a castle or on a river crossing with a hill behind it.
- Use your navy to blockade the 2-3 most active enemy ports. A blockaded port cannot produce new units.
- Spend your stockpiled koku: recruit emergency garrisons in provinces without castles. A single yari ashigaru unit adds +3 happiness and +1 garrison.

Turn 4-7 (the first cracks):

- The AI will attack your best-defended positions first. Let them. Fight every siege defense manually.
- Siege defense is the most lopsided battle in Shogun 2. A garrison of 8 yari ashigaru can defeat 2 full stacks if you fight manually. The defender gets: wall combat bonus, unlimited ammunition for bow units, oil at the gates (kills 100+ models per pour), and reduced fatigue from not moving.
- Pick the weakest enemy army and destroy it with your central reserve. A full stack elimination (-20 units) reduces the total enemy strength significantly. Most AI clans will struggle to replace 20 units quickly.

Turn 8-10 (stabilization):

- The initial AI rush will slow as their armies are depleted.
- Now you counter-attack. Take one strategic province (a trade node, a choke point, or an enemy capital).
- Do not advance beyond one province. Consolidate, repair walls, recruit.

The Siege Timing Formula

Siege offense is the hardest skill in Shogun 2. Here is the exact timing:

1. Arrive at the enemy castle. Build 2 siege towers. This takes 2 turns.
2. Attack on the turn the towers complete. The AI repairs broken walls between turns — do not give them that turn.
3. Deploy both towers on the same wall section. Concentrating your force beats spreading it out.
4. Send 2 units up each tower. While they fight on the walls, send a ram unit to the gate.
5. Once the gate breaks (2-3 turns of ramming), send your cavalry and general through.
6. Capture the center. The battle ends when you hold the center for 60 seconds — you do not need to kill every defender.

Starvation (besieging without attacking): a castle with a full garrison holds 4-6 turns of food on Normal difficulty. After food runs out, the garrison takes 20% casualties per turn. On turn 4 of starvation, the garrison is at 50% strength. Starving is safer than assaulting but gives the enemy time to reinforce. Only starve tier-4 castles (Citadel+) where assaulting would cost too many lives.

Navy Dominance

Naval power is the most overlooked mechanic by intermediate players. Here is how it works:

Ship types:

- **Bow Kobaya:** Fast, cheap, 15 crew. Use for scouting and trade node occupation.
- **Bow Medium:** 40 crew, 10 bowmen. Your standard fighting ship. Can blockade ports.
- **Wako (Rise of the Samurai):** Heaviest normal ship. Very effective in boarding actions.
- **Black Ship:** Unique Portuguese carrack. 60 crew, 20 cannon (refire). One-shots any other ship. Captured via boarding — reduce crew to 30 via cannon fire, then board. Once yours, it wins every naval battle automatically.

Blockade mechanics: A blockaded port cannot recruit ships. A blockaded port generates 50% less tax income. Blockading a clan's only port cuts their naval capacity to zero. Blockade is not an act of war in itself — but the targeted clan will dislike you.

Transport interdiction: Enemy armies at sea on transport ships are the most vulnerable target in the game. A single bow medium ship can sink a transport carrying 20 units. The army is destroyed (only the general survives in most cases). This is the most efficient way to reduce enemy strength — one ship costing 300 koku destroys 20 units worth 5,000+ koku.

Trade node strategy: Never leave a trade node undefended. The AI will try to capture it. Park 2 bow medium ships at each node you control. When an enemy approaches, attack before they reach the node.

Agent Synergies at Scale

Deep into a campaign, you should have 4-5 agents of each type. Coordinate them:

Province disruption chain:

1. Monk: Incite Revolt in target province (reduces happiness by -10 over 3 turns)
2. Ninja: Sabotage Castle Walls (reduces wall HP by 50%)
3. Ninja: Assassinate General (if an army is in the province)
4. Army: Attack with full stack
5. Metsuke: Capture Town (prevents revolt for 3 turns after conquest)

This chain lets one army conquer a tier-4 province with 80% fewer casualties than a direct assault.

The three-agent scout:

1. Ninja (Way of the Wind, max movement skills) moves ahead of the army
2. When the ninja spots an enemy stack, a second ninja (assassination spec) targets the general
3. If the assassination fails, the metsuke (crackdown spec) moves in to arrest any enemy counter-agents

Phase 4: Mastery & Mod Integration

Advanced Province Specialization with Math

The difference between an average player and an expert player is province specialization.

Compound growth calculation: A province developed starting at turn 10 versus turn 50:

- Turn 10 start: 40 turns of compound growth $\times$ 3% per turn = $3.3\times$ baseline wealth
- Turn 50 start: 0 turns of compound growth (war starts soon after) = $1\times$ baseline wealth

This is why developing economy early, even when it feels like you should be recruiting armies, is always correct. One farm built at turn 5 pays for itself by turn 15 and generates pure profit from turn 15-80.

Ideal province grid:

- **Kyoto:** Economic capital. All market slots, metsuke stationed permanently. Towers generate +50% trade income.
- **Your home province:** Military capital. Max castle, all recruitment buildings, armor smith, horse dojo. Produces units in 1 turn.
- **Coastal provinces:** Port + market in every coastal slot. Trade nodes, navy recruitment.
- **Inland farms:** 3-4 farms + road. Nothing else. These are food-only provinces that feed your military provinces.
- **Border provinces:** Castle + road + 1 farm. These are forts — their economic output is secondary to their defensive value.

The Four Army Doctrine

In the late game, organize your armies into four distinct types:

Sweeper army: 14 yari ashigaru, 4 bow ashigaru, 1 general, 1 metsuke. Purpose: capture undefended provinces and serve as emergency garrison. Each unit costs 200-300 koku. A full stack costs 5,000 koku and can be recruited in 2 turns. Use 2-3 sweeper armies to occupy territory faster than the enemy can react.

Strike army: 4 yari, 6 katana, 4 naginata, 2 matchlock, 2 bow, 2 cavalry. Purpose: destroy enemy main forces. This army costs 12,000 koku and takes 5+ turns to recruit. You want 1-2 of these.

Siege army: 6 yari, 2 naginata, 4 matchlock, 6 bow, 2 cavalry. Purpose: capture high-tier castles. Extra ranged units for wall suppression. General has the **Engineer** retinue (faster siege construction).

Naval army: 6 bow medium ships, 2 Wako/Black Ship. Purpose: control the seas, blockade ports, interdict transports. A naval army costs 3,000 koku and takes 3 turns to recruit.

Opening Moves for Hard Clan Campaigns

After completing a campaign as a strong clan (Shimazu, Oda, Tokugawa), try these:

Imagawa (Very Hard start):

- You are sandwiched between Oda to the east and Tokugawa to the west.
- Turn 1: Send a gift of 1,000 koku to Oda. Build a farm. Recruit yari ashigaru.
- Turn 2: Move your army toward Tokugawa. Attack them before they attack you.
- Turns 3-20: Fight a defensive war against Oda while conquering Tokugawa territory. Do not let Oda catch you in the open — fight from castles.
- Key advantage: Imagawa gets +2 honor from trade. Use trade as your economy engine.

Mori (naval focus):

- You control the western trade nodes. Build trade ships on turn 1 and send them to the nearest node.
- Your economy comes from the sea, not the land. You can afford fewer armies but better ones.
- Key advantage: Mori bow ships are the best in the game. Dominate the seas, blockade your enemies, and starve their economies.

Hojo (development focus):

- You start in the Kanto region (eastern Japan) with the highest development potential in the game.
- Build farms and markets in every province for the first 20 turns. Do not recruit more than one army.

- Key advantage: Hojo get +1 to castle tiers. Your castles are always one level above everyone else's. A Hojo tier-3 castle is effectively a tier-4 castle.

Faction Strategy: All Clans by Archetype

Every clan in Shogun 2 plays differently. Beyond individual opening moves, clans fall into strategic archetypes that dictate your long-term approach.

Military Clans (Takeda, Date, Shimazu)

These clans win through superior armies. Your economy exists to fund your military. Expand early and often.

Takeda — The Cavalry Kings:

- Unique units: Takeda Heavy Cavalry (best cavalry in the game), Takeda Fire Cav (higher charge bonus)
- Start province: Kai (mountainous, moderate farm potential)
- Opening strategy: Turn 1, declare war on your eastern neighbor (Satomi or Uesugi). Do not wait. Takeda must expand through aggression because your starting province generates mediocre income. Build farms in Kai, then recruit yari and bow ashigaru alongside cavalry. Your first stable should be upgraded by turn 15.
- Key technology: Cavalry dojo upgrades (priority). Horse Armor (+4 defense for cavalry) transforms your cavalry from strong to unstoppable.
- Strategic note: Takeda cavalry is terrifying but expensive. Each cavalry unit costs 500-600 koku and takes 2 turns to recruit. Do not build an all-cavalry army. Your core should still be yari ashigaru and bow ashigaru — cavalry are the hammer, not the anvil.
- Realm Divide: Takeda struggles defensively because your cavalry excels in the open field, not on walls. Station cavalry armies in the field between your castles, not inside them.

Date — The Samurai Elite:

- Unique units: Date No-Dachi Samurai (high attack, charge bonus), Date Bow Cavalry (mounted archers)
- Start province: Mutsu (far north, isolated, rich in resources)
- Opening strategy: Mutsu is one of the safest starts in the game. You have one direction to expand (south) and no enemies at your back. Build up your economy for 10-15 turns before moving south. Date No-Dachi Samurai are available early and shred ashigaru — use them to overwhelm the northern clans quickly.
- Key technology: Sword upgrades. Date No-Dachi already have the highest attack of any samurai. Upgrading their weapon damage makes them one-shot ashigaru.
- Strategic note: Your isolation is both a blessing and a curse. By the time you reach central Japan, the Oda or Takeda may control 15+ provinces. You must expand fast once you move south — do not stop to develop every province.
- Realm Divide: Date's northern position means you only need to defend a narrow front. Fortify the choke points between north and central Japan and hold them with garrisons.

Shimazu (Advanced) — The Sword of Kyushu:

- Unique units: Shimazu Katana Samurai (best katana samurai in the game — +2 attack over standard), Shimazu Heavy Gunners (matchlock with higher armor)
- Start province: Satsuma (southern Kyushu, moderate farms, good trade)
- Opening strategy (advanced): Your beginner campaign taught you the basics. On harder difficulties or with mods, Shimazu's game is unification speed. You should control all of Kyushu by turn 20-25. Build a second army by turn 10 and expand north and east simultaneously.

- Key technology: Katana dojo upgrades. Shimazu Katana Samurai with full upgrades beat everything except cavalry charges and naginata walls.
- Strategic note: Shimazu is the best beginner clan because they are forgiving. In expert hands, they are lethal because their economy (Kyushu trade) and military (best katana) combine to produce unstoppable mid-game armies.

Economic Clans (Hojo, Mori, Chosokabe)

These clans win through superior resources. Your economy funds more armies than your opponents can field.

Hojo (Advanced) — The Castle Builders:

- Unique bonus: +1 castle tier (a tier-2 castle is effectively tier-3 for recruitment and garrison)
- Start province: Sagami (Kanto region, richest farmland in Japan)
- Opening strategy (advanced): Do not expand militarily for the first 20-25 turns. Develop every Kanto province to maximum farms and markets. You will be behind in provinces but ahead in total economic output by turn 25. Once your economy is established, field 2-3 full armies and expand outward — your economic lead lets you out-recruit any opponent.
- Key technology: Castle upgrades (all levels). Hojo's unique bonus makes your castles one tier higher for defense purposes. A tier-4 Hojo castle requires 2+ full enemy stacks to besiege effectively.
- Strategic note: Hojo economy snowballs harder than any other clan. A farm built at turn 5 in Hojo hands generates compound growth for 50+ turns. By turn 40, your per-province income should be 2x any neighbor's.

Mori (Advanced) — The Sea Lords:

- Unique units: Mori Bow Warriors (best bow ships in the game — +20 crew, +5 range)
- Start province: Aki (western Honshu, coastal, access to trade nodes)
- Opening strategy: Mori's game is naval domination. Build 3-4 trade ships on turn 1 and claim the western trade nodes. Use your naval income to fund a smaller but elite army. Do not expand inland — take coastal provinces and use ports for income. Your navy blockades enemy ports while your army takes undefended coastal settlements.
- Key technology: Naval tech (all). Bow ship upgrades turn your already-dominant navy into an unstoppable force. A Mori navy at full upgrades can defeat 3x its number in enemy ships.
- Strategic note: Mori's weakness is inland expansion. You have limited farm potential in your starting provinces. If an enemy clan cuts you off from the coast, your economy collapses. Keep a reserve army near your capital to defend against inland attacks.

Chosokabe — The Archer Lords:

- Unique units: Chosokabe Bow Samurai (best archers in the game — +5 range, +3 accuracy), Chosokabe Bow Cavalry (mounted archers with extra range)
- Start province: Tosa (Shikoku island, isolated, moderate farms)
- Opening strategy: Unify Shikoku island by turn 10. Shikoku is isolated and has only 3-4 provinces — you can control it quickly. Build a navy to defend the straits. Your bow dominance means you win battles before the enemy reaches your line. Use lots of bow units (8-10 per army) and let them soften the enemy while your yari hold the line.
- Key technology: Bow upgrades (priority). Chosokabe Bow Samurai with max upgrades outrange every other ranged unit in the game. They can shoot enemy matchlocks before the matchlocks are in range.

- Strategic note: Chosokabe is weak in melee. Your katana and yari units are standard quality. Do not rely on them to win fights — your bows do the killing, your infantry just holds the line. Protect your bows with yari walls.

Religious Clans (Ikko-Ikki, Otomo)

These clans use religion as a weapon. Your unique units and mechanics revolve around faith.

Ikko-Ikki — The Warrior Monks:

- Unique units: Warrior Monks (high attack, high morale, causes fear, large unit size), Ikko-Ikki Bow Monks (monks with bows), Ikko-Ikki Cavalry Monks (mounted monks)
- Unique mechanic: Ikko-Ikki starting religion is Ikko (a Buddhist sect). Provinces with Ikko religion get +5 happiness instead of the standard +3. Provinces with Shinto get -5 instead of -3.
- Start province: Kaga (central Honshu, near Kyoto)
- Opening strategy: Ikko-Ikki starts surrounded by enemies who hate you (your religion is incompatible with Shinto). Your early game is survival. Build farms first, recruit monks (available from the temple chain), and use warrior monks as your frontline. A warrior monk unit beats a katana samurai unit in a straight fight — use this to win battles despite having fewer provinces.
- Key technology: Temple upgrades (all). Warrior Monks are recruited from upgraded temples. Higher-tier temples produce better monks.
- Strategic note: Ikko-Ikki cannot ally with Shinto clans easily. Your diplomacy is limited. Plan for permanent war with most neighbors. Incite Revolt (monk skill) is your best offensive weapon — triggering rebellions in enemy provinces weakens them without spending your own troops.
- Realm Divide: Ikko-Ikki's religious penalty means Realm Divide hits you harder. Every clan will already hate you. Prepare 2 full defensive armies before crossing 20 provinces.

Otomo — The Christians:

- Unique units: Otomo Matchlock Samurai (best matchlock units in the game — higher accuracy, faster reload), Otomo Christian Archers (archers with bonus vs armored units)
- Unique mechanic: Otomo are Christian. Christian provinces get +5 happiness and a unique building chain (church to cathedral) that provides research and income. Shinto provinces get -8 happiness instead of -3.
- Start province: Bungo (northern Kyushu)
- Opening strategy: Otomo starts in a strong position (Kyushu) but with severe religious penalties. Convert your starting province to Christianity on turn 1 (use your missionary). Build churches instead of temples. Your matchlock units are available earlier than any other clan's gunpowder — use them to dominate the mid game. Expand south through Kyushu first (Shimazu's territory), then east toward central Japan.
- Key technology: Gunpowder tech (priority). Matchlock range and accuracy upgrades make your Otomo matchlocks the most lethal ranged units in the game. A volley from Otomo Matchlock Samurai can route a samurai unit in 2 shots.
- Strategic note: Otomo's religious penalty is severe. Every Shinto province you conquer will rebel unless you convert it. This costs monk actions and time. Focus on converting high-value provinces and leave border provinces unconverted (use garrisons to suppress revolts).
- Realm Divide: Otomo has the hardest Realm Divide because every clan's religious hatred stacks on top of the fame penalty. You need stronger garrisons and more armies than any other clan at Realm Divide.

Balanced Clans (Oda, Tokugawa, Uesugi)

These clans have broad strengths but no single dominant aspect. Your strategy adapts to circumstances.

Oda (Advanced) — The Demon King:

- Unique units: Oda Yari Ashigaru (ashigaru with +2 melee attack and +2 morale — almost as good as samurai), Oda Matchlock Ashigaru (cheapest matchlock units in the game)
- Unique mechanic: Oda's ashigaru are better than any other clan's. You can field ashigaru armies that perform at samurai level for half the cost.
- Start province: Owari (central Honshu, near Kyoto)
- Opening strategy (advanced): Oda's strength is volume. You can recruit an army of 20 yari ashigaru in 2 turns for 4,000 koku. Use this to overwhelm opponents through sheer numbers. Your mid-game transition adds matchlock ashigaru — 4-6 per army gives you firepower without the cost of samurai. Your late-game army should still be mostly ashigaru with a samurai core (katana and naginata).
- Key technology: Ashigaru upgrades (Metsuke skill: Oversight, and the Honma Ashigaru tech tree). These upgrades turn your already-strong ashigaru into lineholders that can fight samurai evenly.
- Strategic note: Oda's weakness is the late game. Your ashigaru advantage fades when every clan has tier-4 units. You must win the game before turn 80, or your economic lead disappears. Push aggressive expansion from turn 1.

Tokugawa (Advanced) — The Shadow Shogun:

- Unique units: Tokugawa Ninja (best ninja in the game — +2 to all agent actions), Tokugawa Shinobi (cavalry with bonus in forests)
- Unique mechanic: Tokugawa starts as a vassal of the Imagawa. You must win a war of independence before you can expand freely.
- Start province: Mikawa (central Honshu, between Imagawa and Oda)
- Opening strategy (advanced): Your first 10 turns are about breaking free from the Imagawa. Build up quietly (farms and markets) while paying tribute. When you have 1.5 stacks of ashigaru, declare war on Imagawa and destroy them in 5-7 turns. After independence, your game is diplomacy and agents — use your superior ninja to assassinate enemy generals and sabotage enemy buildings. You should fight one war at a time using agents to soften the next target.
- Key technology: Ninja upgrades (all). Tokugawa ninja can assassinate generals with 60-70% success rate at rank 3. This is your main military advantage.
- Strategic note: Tokugawa's position is precarious. You are surrounded by powerful clans (Imagawa, Oda, Takeda). Do not fight multiple wars. Use marriage and gifts to keep 2 of your 3 borders peaceful while you conquer the third.
- Realm Divide: Tokugawa's agent advantage shines during Realm Divide. Assassinate the generals of incoming armies — a general-less army has -12 morale and will rout quickly.

Uesugi — The Warrior Monks of the North:

- Unique units: Uesugi Warrior Monks (same as Ikko-Ikki but available from Shinto temples), Uesugi Cavalry Monks (mounted warrior monks)
- Unique mechanic: Uesugi is a Shinto clan but gets access to warrior monk units (normally reserved for Buddhist/Ikko clans). Your monks do not cause religious unrest because they follow your state religion.
- Start province: Echigo (northern Honshu, mountainous, moderate farms)

- Opening strategy: Uesugi starts in the north with one direction of expansion (south and east). Unify the northern provinces by turn 15-20. Build a mix of standard samurai and warrior monks. Your warrior monks are your elite units — use them as a breakthrough force. Uesugi's economy is weaker than the southern clans (less farm space), so you must expand to survive.
- Key technology: Temple upgrades (for warrior monks) and cavalry upgrades (for cavalry monks). A mix of naginata, warrior monks, and cavalry monks creates an army with no clear weakness.
- Strategic note: Uesugi struggles economically. You will always have fewer provinces and less income than the Oda or Takeda. Your advantage is unit quality — warrior monks beat samurai, and cavalry monks are excellent for flanking. Win through quality, not quantity.
- Realm Divide: Your northern position gives you a secure rear (no enemies behind you). Fortify the southern choke points and use your elite armies to destroy enemy stacks as they arrive.

Realm Divide: The Minimal Province Strategy

The most advanced Realm Divide strategy is to deliberately delay it:

1. Stay below 22 provinces. Never cross the threshold.
2. Raze (sack + abandon) provinces beyond 22 instead of occupying them.
3. Build 3-4 fully-developed core provinces with max-tier farms, markets, and castles.
4. Build 4 full strike armies.
5. In one turn: occupy 5-10 razed provinces (they cost nothing militarily — no garrisons).
6. Realm Divide triggers. You now have 30+ provinces and 4 full armies.
7. The initial AI wave hits your well-fortified core provinces and breaks against them.
8. Counter-attack with your strike armies while the AI is recovering from their failed offensive.

This strategy requires discipline. Every time you see an undefended province and want to take it, ask: **Is this province worth triggering Realm Divide over?** If the answer is no, raze it.

Moving Beyond

After completing this curriculum, you have mastered Total War: SHOGUN 2. The game opens into new challenges:

- **Multiplayer:** The competitive scene on Steam uses house rules (no matchlock spam, no cavalry doomstacks). Join the Shogun 2 discord for organized matches.
- **Modding:** Use the Assembly Kit (free on Steam) to create custom units, factions, and campaign maps. The TWC modding forums have tutorials.
- **Legendary difficulty:** No manual saves, no pausing, the AI gets maximum bonuses. Complete a Legendary campaign as every clan.

Quick Reference — Recommended Learning Path

Stage	Clan	Difficulty	Focus	Mod Intensity
Tutorial	—	Normal	Controls & basics	None / Light
Early Campaign	Date / Shimazu	Normal	Economy + Army building	Light
Military Focus	Takeda / Oda	Normal–Hard	Battles & Composition	Medium
Realm Divide	Any	Hard	Strategy & Pressure management	Medium–Full

Mastery Weak clans Hard–Very Hard Full systems + Mods Full Tenka Fubu